

GST Council slashes tax rates on EVs, chargers

Federal indirect tax body Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council has decided to reduce tax rates on electric vehicles (EVs) and chargers from August 1. These have been reduced from twelve to five per cent on vehicles, and from eighteen to five per cent on EV chargers. The Council has also made hiring of electric buses by local authorities tax-free.

Prasad exhorts telecom industry to make India a hub for telecom equipment manufacturing

Telecom minister Ravi Shankar Prasad has exhorted the telecommunications sector to make India a hub for telecom equipment manufacturing. He said that India is on its way to becoming a global power with the march of technology and has asked the telecom industry to focus on innovation around 5G technology to create products with India-specific patents.

HP to invest US\$ 500 million in India to start manufacturing before the end of 2019

Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) has announced its plan to invest US\$ 500 million in India over the next five years. This strategic investment underscores HPE's long-term commitment to India and will enable the company to grow its operations, manufacturing base and employee strength in the country.

Google, Cisco to roll out free Wi-Fi zones in India

Cisco and Google have announced their plans to roll out free high-speed Wi-Fi zones across India with Google's gStation. Cisco will work with gStation platform to provide communities

access to free, open, high-quality public Wi-Fi networks around the country. The service is already live at 25 locations across Bengaluru, within the next few months it will be available at 500 locations across the city.

Wipro, IISc collaborate for advanced research in autonomous systems, robotics and 5G

Wipro has entered into a strategic partnership with Indian Institute of Science (IISc) to conduct advanced applied research in autonomous systems, robotics and 5G space. The two organisations have jointly set up Wipro IISc Research and Innovation Network (WIRIN), a hybrid industry academia collaboration unit, which will drive idea discovery, research and innovation in technology and product design.

EESL to install hundred charging stations in NOIDA, UP

Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL), a joint venture of PSUs under Ministry of Power, government of India, has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with New Okhla Industrial Development Authority (NOIDA) to promote electric vehicles (EVs) and install around hundred public charging stations. The MoU will fast-track the adoption of e-mobility in NOIDA by establishing a robust EV infrastructure.

Birmingham University launches solar project with India

University of Birmingham has launched a new project to build on its research partnership with India-led International Solar Alliance (ISA) and help farmers in sun-rich countries make the most of chilled food distribution systems powered by solar and solar-hybrid solutions, reports *PTI*.

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Name, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
21st Electronic Components & Materials Expo January 15-17, 2020 Tokyo Big Sight, Japan	Exhibition for electronic components and materials in Japan	Reed Exhibitions Japan Ltd (NEPCON JAPAN Show Management) Website: www.nepconjapan.jp
India Electronics Week February 13-15, 2020 KTPO Trade Center, Whitefield Industrial Area, Bengaluru	Mega electronics and technology show with multiple co-located events including expositions, conferences and seminars	EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd Website: www.indiaelectronicsweek.com
IoTShow.in February 13-15, 2020 KTPO Trade Center, Whitefield Industrial Area, Bengaluru	Everything you would like to know about the Internet of Things	EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd Website: www.iotshow.in
Smart Energy Summit February 17-19, 2020 Austin, USA	Focuses on such topics as smart home and energy efficiency, adoption and innovative business models, smart home and demand response, and much more	Parks Associates Website: www.parksassociates.com
Convergence India 2020 February 19-21, 2020 Pragati Maidan, New Delhi	Communications, broadcast, IT and technology show	Convergence India 2020 Website: www.convergenceindia.org
Hong Kong Electronics Fair 2020 April 13-16, 2020 Hong Kong Convention and Exhibition Centre, Hong Kong	Covers the entire gamut of electronics	Hong Kong Trade Development Council Website: https://event.hktdc.com
Electronics Show 2020 May 8-10, 2020 Ptak Warsaw Expo, Nadarzyn, Poland	Consumer electronics and new technology trade show in Poland	Ptak Warsaw Expo Website: https://electronics-show.com

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

good growth over the past few years, according to India LED Lighting Market Overview 2022.

The LED lighting segment, which initially struggled to gain market share, has finally seen a tremendous growth spurt, with a CAGR of more than forty per cent over the last six years. Major factors behind this are the government's initiatives of providing 9W LED bulbs at a cheaper rate than the market as well as the programme to replace traditional streetlights with LEDs.

Other factors that have made a significant impact are the advertisements for increasing the awareness about LED lights, as well as the new architectural designs that have given a boost to the growth of LED panels and downlights.

India's LED lighting market has been witnessing tremendous growth in terms of value as well as volume. With more than seventy per cent of the Indian lighting market being occupied by the CFLs and incandescent lights, LEDs have a huge opportunity.